

Finally, remember that a good blog on a little-discussed topic, one that caters to a niche audience, has a good chance of being a success. It's as with anything else—if you don't have too much competition, you can create your own space. Think about uncommon things that interest you.

3.4 Links And Sources

Depending on your writing style, you'll need fewer or more links in your blog posts. If you mostly write (hopefully thoughtful and thought-provoking) essays, which are almost entirely personal opinions, you won't need too many links. But if your blog is more conventional, you'll probably want to link a lot.

For example, if you maintain a technology blog, you might want to incorporate a lot of links—some links at the end of the page for more on the topic, and the post itself peppered with links here and there, pointing to, say, Answers.com, or Wikipedia. The links along your post should serve a purpose: to make some terms clear, or to lend credence to your post.

Do *not* overdo it! Most people find too many links a put-off. For example, on Wikipedia, half the words seem to be links—if an article says so-and-so died on the 4th of January, the word “died” might probably link to the Wikipedia entry for “death.” This might work on a site such as Wikipedia, but it's a bad idea for a blog. Strike the balance. Try and put in just the right number of links.

Sources are a must. As it is, the Web can sometimes seem chaotic, and there is mass confusion over some topics: you don't want your post to add to the confusion. If it's a personal opinion, indicate that clearly either by explicitly stating the fact, or by letting it emerge in the way you write. If it's *not* just a personal opinion, you should definitely quote your sources and hyperlink them. Remember here that the more credible your source, the more credible your blog post will be—naturally.